



Contact Sheet

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The Freecom FHD-2 PRO 80GB

quite high, and could be due to the external interface bringing in an overhead.

In HDTach 2.7, the TS0GSJ25 40GB logged 22.2 MBps of sequential read, followed by the TS0GSJ25 20GB which logged 21.9 seconds. The Transcend TS20GSJ18 20 GB drive managed just 10 MBps. In the sequential write speed test, the Transcend TS0GSJ25 20 GB logged the highest value—30.7 MBps—which is awesome.

However, this drive also needed 25.7 per cent of the CPU cycles; only the TS0GHDC2 30GB was hungrier for attention, demanding an even higher 26.4 per cent.

In the real-world performance test, for the sequential read test, the Freecom FHD-2 Pro took 54.93

seconds to read a 1 GB image off a local drive. The Transcend TS0GSJ25 40 GB took 167.86 seconds for the same test on the same machine over the same interface.

In the assorted read test, the Transcend TS0GSJ25 20 GB took 58.51 seconds to read hundreds of small and large files from a local drive.

The TS0GSJ25 40 GB took 163.82 seconds. These times are quite high. In the assorted write test, the Transcend TS0GSJ25 60 GB took 72.26 seconds, whereas the Transcend TS20GSJ25 20GB took 164.05 seconds. It is strange that these drives, both from the same vendor, gave such varied results.

Conclusion

Overall, it was the Freecom FHD-2 Pro that secured the Digit Best Buy Gold award—thanks to its performance, decent features and lowest price per MB. The drive looks decent and also has a large storage capacity—80 GB.

The Silver winner, the Transcend TS0GSJ25 60GB, also sported good storage capacity of 60 GB. The drive returned a commendable performance score, and had good features. The price per MB was a little higher at 28 paise, than our Gold winner.

All 1.8-inch drives make good companions for those who need to carry their data with them. If portability is not of prime importance, it makes sense to go for a 2.5-inch drive, for the best mix of performance, features and portability. ☐

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The Transcend StoreJet TS0GSJ25 60GB